Daily Bible Note

Date: 2026-11-07

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: Amos 3:1-8

1 Hear this word that the Lord has spoken against you, O children of Israel, against the whole family which I brought up from the land of Egypt, saying:

2 "You only have I known of all the families of the earth; therefore I will punish you for all your iniquities."

3 Can two walk together, unless they are agreed?

4 Will a lion roar in the forest, when he has no prey? Will a young lion cry out of his den, if he has caught nothing?

5 Will a bird fall into a snare on the earth, where there is no trap for it? Will a snare spring up from the earth, if it has caught nothing at all?

6 If a trumpet is blown in a city, will not the people be afraid? If there is calamity in a city, will not the Lord have done it?

7 Surely the Lord God does nothing, unless He reveals His secret to His servants the prophets.

8 A lion has roared! Who will not fear? The Lord God has spoken! Who can but prophesy?

II. Key Summary

• The Lord speaks to the whole family of Israel that He brought up from Egypt: "You only have I known of all the families of the earth; therefore I will punish you for all your iniquities" (vv. 1–2).

• Amos asks question after question: can two walk together unless they are agreed, will a lion roar with no prey, will a bird fall into a snare with no trap, will people not be afraid when a trumpet is blown; if there is calamity in a city, will not the Lord have done it (vv. 3–6)?

• The Lord God does nothing unless He reveals His secret to His servants the prophets; a

lion has roared, who will not fear? The Lord God has spoken, who can but prophesy (vv. 7–8)?

III. Passage Analysis

"Therefore" Leads to Punishment

> Israel received especially rich favor in God's way; the more grace they received, the stricter God's demands became, and the more severe His rebuke. Enjoying prosperity and success, the Israelites grew self-satisfied and forgot the responsibility they were meant to bear. [1]

In chapters 1–2 the judgment circles closer and closer until it lands on Israel (2:6-16); in chapter 3 Amos speaks to Israel directly: "Hear this word." Verse 1 says, "the whole family which I brought up from the land of Egypt," and verse 2, "You only have I known of all the families of the earth"—here "known" means entering a close relationship with God [1]. The very next word, "therefore," leads to "I will punish you for all your iniquities."

Being known by God is grace, and it comes with responsibility.

Hearing Calls for a Response

> This is a series of cause-and-effect questions. Their purpose is to show that the prophet's message comes from God: since he has given a warning of judgment, it must be because God is about to send disaster, so those who hear should respond. [1]

Each question in verses 3–6 pairs a result with its cause: two walk together because they are agreed, a lion roars because it has prey, a snare springs up because it has caught something, people are afraid because a trumpet is blown. Then verse 8: "A lion has roared! Who will not fear? The Lord God has spoken! Who can but prophesy?" Israel had commanded the prophets, "Do not prophesy!" (2:12), yet God's word was still spoken.

God's word has been spoken; now it is the hearers' turn.

IV. Reflection Question

Think of the person around you who knows you best and reminds you most often. They don't remind you for no reason. How do you usually respond to their reminders?

Of all the families of the earth, Israel was the only one the Lord knew (v. 2). When calamity comes to a city, it is the Lord who has done it (v. 6); yet before bringing disaster, "Surely the Lord God does nothing, unless He reveals His secret to His servants the prophets" (v. 7).

References

[1] 華人基督徒查經資料網站 (Chinese Christian Bible Study), Amos Chapter 3 Notes (《啟導本註釋》，《串珠聖經註釋》), https://www.ccbiblestudy.org/Old%20Testament/30Amos/30GT03.htm